



School Leadership · Session 4

# Learning Design

# Students come first

Move from understanding to design without turning students into a list of problems.

Start with the real students you have in mind, a specific access question and evidence from your school-day map and audit. The design response comes after understanding.

# Culture is something leaders shape

What staff say about students when they are not in the room follows what leaders model.

## Staffroom language

Interrupt deficit talk kindly, every time.

## What gets celebrated

Name inclusive practice publicly and specifically.

## A vision staff can say

One sentence about inclusion that every staff member could repeat.

## Your Autistic staff

A safe culture helps them too, disclosed or not.

**Leaders set the conditions that make inclusive classrooms possible.**

# Resourcing as strategy

Where money and staff time go shows what the school values.

## Support staff allocation

Is it based on need, or on habit?

## Follow the evidence

Use your school-day map and audit to decide where support goes.

## Low-cost changes

Warning time, a stable timetable and good templates cost little.

## Records and funding

Good records of practice also support NCCD and funding.

Who decided your current support staff allocation, and when?

# Leading change

Change that lasts usually starts small and visible.

## Start with one system

Do it well and celebrate it.

## Explain why

Staff need to know the reason for the change.

## Support the middle

Resource and protect the staff who lead it day to day.

## Review on a cycle

Check what is working and adjust.

Staff follow what leaders do more than what they write.

# How this session runs

Short inputs, then doing. You work in trios on one school system.

**1**

## Start

14 min · Three inputs,  
then move

**2**

## Brief

6 min · Trios

**3**

## Options

12 min · Input, then trios

**4**

## Universal first

6 min · Trios

**5**

## Design

12 min · Trios

**6**

## Check

5 min · On your own,  
private

**7**

## Continuum

7 min · Input

**8**

## Gallery and commit

9 min · Whole room

You will leave with one school change, planned for this term, this year and the strategic plan.

# Regroup

**Bring back your Carry into design card from Session 3.**

Move to the corner of the room for the system you want to work on:

**Culture and learning**

**Routines**

**Teams and resourcing**

Form a trio with two people near you. Each of you keeps your own school and your students in mind.

**5 minutes**

# Keep your students in view

Hold a concise picture of each of the students you have in mind, including:

**Strengths, interests  
and joy**

**Communication,  
sensory experience  
and thinking**

**What costs and what  
lightens**

**Identity and belonging**

**What students,  
families and the team  
already know**

**Questions that remain  
open**

**You are not building a file on one child. Keep real, different students in view as you design.**

# Write your trio's brief

Agree on one school system you all recognise, then write an environment-first brief.

**At the moment, this system asks students to...**

**For some students and staff, that means...**

**We could change...**

**Check the wording: is it specific, workable and free from blame or deficit labels?**

# Options menu

Four short inputs. Listen for what might answer your brief.

**1**

## Professional learning and coaching

Staff learning that continues through the year

**2**

## Predictability as policy

Relief-day plans, change warnings, a stable timetable

**3**

## Inclusion team and review cycles

Adjustments planned and reviewed on a schedule

**4**

## Documentation that helps staff

Templates, profiles that travel, a resource bank

Printed option cards are on your table. After the inputs, your trio chooses one or two.

# Professional learning and coaching

**Build staff learning into the year:**

**Learning that continues after today**

**Coaching and mentoring in classrooms**

**Time to plan and review together**

**A mentor for every early career teacher**

**Today is one step. Plan what comes next for your staff.**

# Predictability as policy

**Predictability includes clear information about routine and change.**

Can every student, and every relief teacher, answer:



**What is  
happening?**



**What is  
changing?**



**What comes  
next?**



**What can I do if  
the plan  
changes?**

**Relief-day plans, change warnings and a stable timetable are school decisions.**

# Inclusion team and review cycles

**A small team that plans, reviews and retires adjustments on a schedule, not only when there is a crisis.**

Decide who is on it, how often it meets, how students and families are included, and how decisions reach every teacher.

A large, light purple rectangular area with a dashed border, serving as a placeholder for an image.

Image placeholder

**Who reviews adjustments in your school, and how often?**

# Documentation that helps staff

Image placeholder

## Templates and tools

Profiles that travel, adjustment records and a resource bank staff will use.

**Documentation should help staff do the right thing without adding paperwork.**

Keep templates short, store them where staff will find them, and make sure information about a student reaches every teacher who needs it.

## Quick review of your documentation

- Can staff find it when they need it?
- Is it short enough to use?
- Does it reflect what is happening now?
- Does it reach relief teachers?

# Choose your options

Which one or two options answer your brief?

☐

## Professional learning and coaching

Staff learning that continues through the year

☐

## Predictability as policy

Relief-day plans, change warnings, a stable timetable

☐

## Inclusion team and review cycles

Adjustments planned and reviewed on a schedule

☐

## Documentation that helps staff

Templates, profiles that travel, a resource bank

Write down why the option fits: which demand in your school does it answer?

Record your choice, and why, on your A3 sheet, section 2.

# Universal Design for Learning

## Apply a Universal Design for Learning lens to the emerging design:

- Make important information clear and available
- Offer workable ways to participate and respond
- Support engagement without removing meaningful challenge

Individual knowledge and universal design can inform each other.

Design Multiple Means of  
**Engagement** →



Design Multiple Means of  
**Representation** →



Design Multiple Means of  
**Action & Expression** →



# Accessibility check

Run these over your draft design, then test it through use and feedback.

☐ Can students find and understand what they need?

☐ Can they take part in more than one way?

☐ Can they pause, ask for help or recover?

☐ Is the support available when demand increases?

# Design your school change

As a trio, develop the change on your A3 sheet, section 4.

- 1 This term: a decision that costs little.
- 2 This year: what you will build.
- 3 The strategic plan: what makes it last.
- 4 Decide what you will observe.
- 5 Set a time to review.

Ask the trio next to you to check the design remains student-centred.

# Check the design against your students

On your own card, test your trio’s design against each of your students.

|           | Helps | No difference | Needs something more |
|-----------|-------|---------------|----------------------|
| Student A |       |               |                      |
| Student B |       |               |                      |
| Student C |       |               |                      |

Where the design still doesn’t work for someone, that is where targeted or individual support begins.

# Continuum of support

Support is a continuum rather than a single intervention.

**1**

## **Inclusive environment**

First, design inclusive environments that reduce barriers for everyone.

**2**

## **Universal supports**

Then, provide universal supports that many students may benefit from.

**3**

## **Targeted supports**

Next, offer targeted supports for students who need additional assistance.

**4**

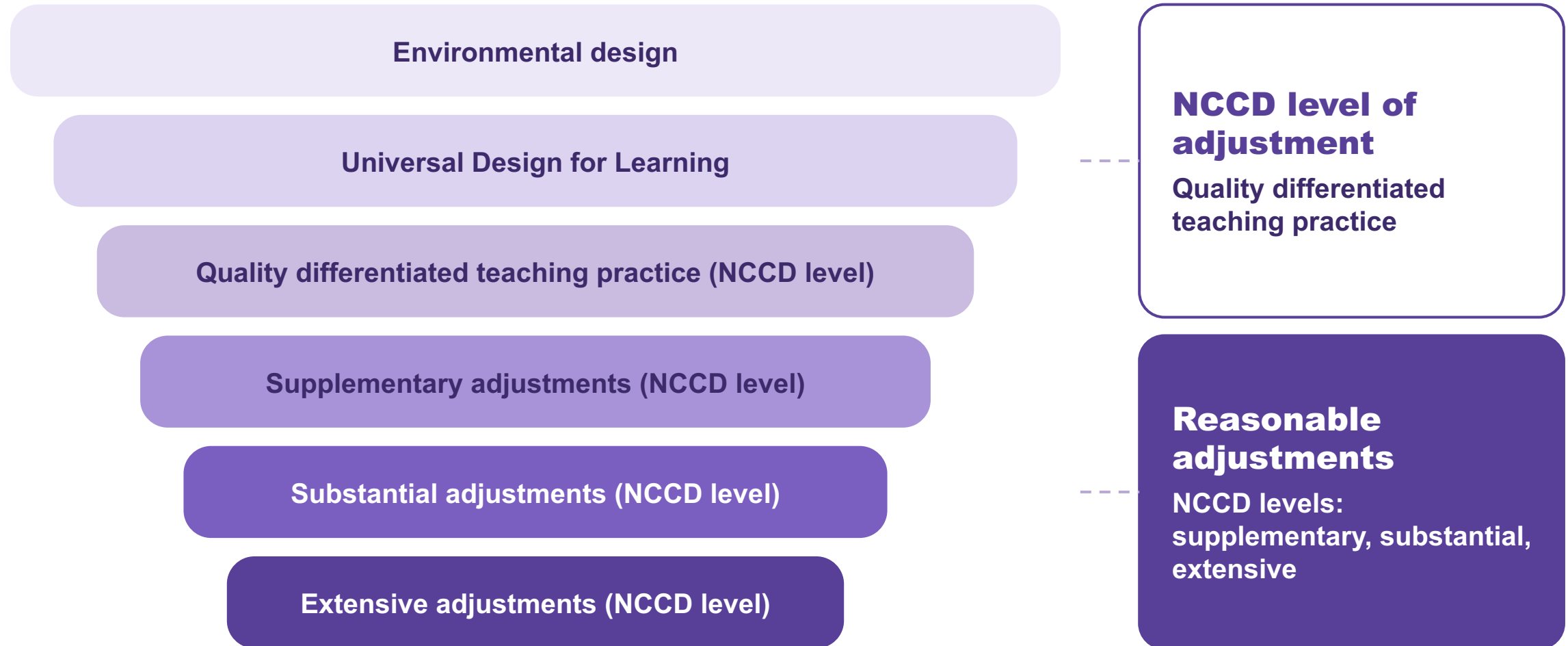
## **Individual adjustments**

Finally, where necessary, implement individual adjustments to ensure equitable access, participation and learning.

## **Academic adjustments sit within a wider continuum of support.**

Consider what is available to everyone, what is targeted and what is individually adjusted. Each response should connect to access and participation needs and be reviewed through use and feedback.

# Reasonable Adjustments



# NCCD

## NCCD information and links

Good practice creates the evidence: consultation records, documented adjustments and review cycles. Leaders decide what evidence staff gather and how easy it is to record. Follow your school or system processes.



# Gallery walk

**See what other trios designed.**

- 1** Put your A3 design on the wall.
- 2** Walk the gallery. On another trio's design, leave a Post-it: one idea you would borrow, or one question.
- 3** Return to your own design and read what others left.

**9 minutes, with commit**

# Share, refine and commit



## After the gallery, ask yourself:

- What will you start this term?
- What will you notice?
- Who on your executive will you share it with?
- How will students and families help refine it?

**Treat the change as something to try, review and refine.**